

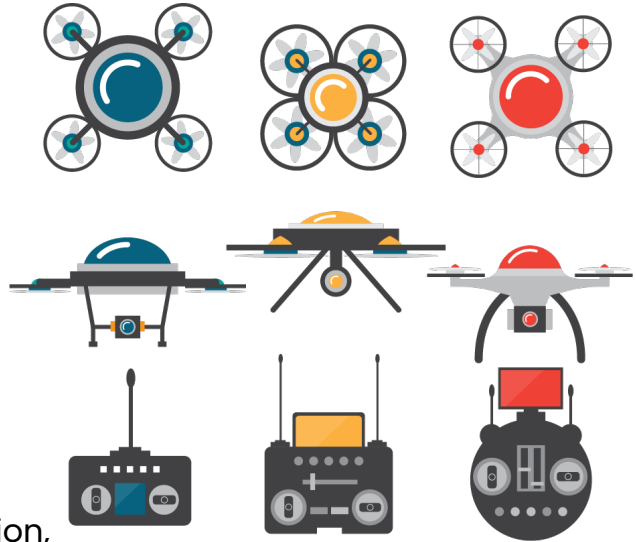
DGCA Rules and Regulations

Here is a breakdown of some key considerations of DGCA:

1. Categories of Drones: Drones are classified based on their maximum take-off weight (MTOW):

- **Nano:** Up to 250 grams.
- **Micro:** 250 grams to 2 kg.
- **Small:** 2 kg to 25 kg.
- **Medium:** 25 kg to 150 kg.
- **Large:** Above 150 kg.

Each category has specific regulations regarding registration, operation, and usage.



Alt text: Different types of drones

2. Registration and Permit: All drones, except those in the Nano category, must be registered with the DGCA. The process includes:

- **Digital Sky Platform:** An online portal for drone registration and obtaining necessary permits.



Alt text: Girl registering through mobile illustration

- **Unique Identification Number (UIN):** A mandatory identification number for each registered drone.
- **Unmanned Aircraft Operator Permit (UAOP):** Required for commercial and non-commercial drone operations. Registration ensures accountability and facilitates the monitoring of drone activities within the country.

3. Operational Restrictions: There are specific areas where drone flights are restricted or prohibited to ensure safety and security:

- **No-fly Zones:** Areas within 5 km of airports, international borders, strategic locations like military installations, and other sensitive zones.
- **Population Density:** Operations over densely populated areas and public gatherings are generally prohibited.
- **Altitude Restrictions:** Drones must not fly above a certain altitude without special permission (typically 400 feet above ground level).

These restrictions are designed to prevent accidents and ensure drones do not interfere with manned aircraft or sensitive operations.



Alt text: Prohibited area for drone flying

4. Pilot Requirements: Drone pilots must meet certain qualifications and undergo training to ensure safe operation:

- **Age Requirement:** Pilots must be at least 18 years old.
- **Training Programs:** Completion of a DGCA-approved training program covering theory, practical flying, and safety protocols.
- **Adherence to Guidelines:** Pilots must maintain a visual line of sight (VLOS) with the drone at all times and avoid flying at night or in adverse weather conditions without special permission.

Proper training and adherence to guidelines help ensure that drone pilots can operate their UAVs safely and responsibly.

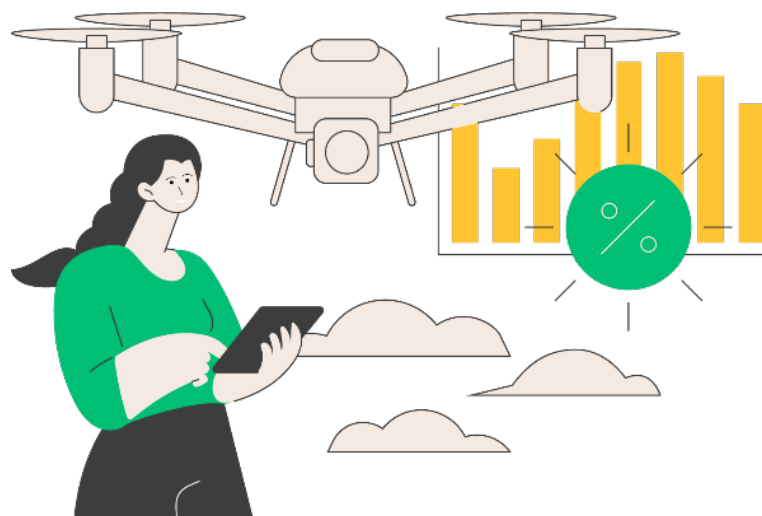
5. Flight Permissions:



Alt text: No drone zone

- **Prior Permission Requirement:** Most drone operations require prior permission from the Digital Sky platform, except for Nano drones operating below 50 feet. This ensures that all flights are monitored and regulated to prevent accidents and unauthorized activity.
- **Flight Plan Submission:** Operators must submit detailed flight plans through the Digital Sky portal. These plans include information about the drone, pilot, area of operation, and purpose of the flight. This allows authorities to assess the potential risks and ensure compliance with regulations.

6. Safety and Compliance:



Alt text: Drone safety



- **Adherence to Standards:** Drones must meet prescribed safety standards, including equipment requirements, maintenance procedures, and operational limitations. This ensures that the drones are safe and reliable, minimizing the risk of accidents or damage.
- **Operator Responsibility:** Operators are responsible for ensuring the safe conduct of drone operations and compliance with all applicable regulations. This includes following proper procedures, maintaining equipment, and avoiding prohibited areas.

7. Penalties for Violations:

Violations of DGCA regulations can result in severe penalties, including fines, suspension, or cancellation of registration, permits, or licenses. The severity of the penalty depends on the nature and extent of the violation.